

Coursework Assignment Brief

Assessment - Postgraduate

Academic Year 2025-26

Module Title: Individual Master's Project			
Module Code: CMP7200			
Assessment Type Coursework	Level 7	Weighting 100	Word Count/Workload 12,000 words
Submission Date Assessment 1: 22 June 2026 Assessment 2: 7 Sep 2026 Assessment 3: 7 Sep 2026	Submission Time 3 PM	Module Leader Samer Bamansoor	Time Limit -

Assessment Information	
The assessment for the CMP7200 Individual Master's Project is divided into three main tasks, each contributing to the total module weight. The first task is a Project Proposal, requiring a comprehensive individual report that includes elements such as background rationale, project aim, objectives, literature review, research methodology, and a project schedule. The second task is the Project Dissertation, demanding an in-depth written report showcasing critical analysis and understanding of the research area. The third task, Project Viva Voce, involves an oral presentation where students defend their project approach and conclusions, supported by a PowerPoint presentation.	
Assessment Summary	Task 1 Project Proposal (20% of total module weight) Task 2 Project Report Task (60% of total module weight) Task 3 Viva Voce Task (20% of total module weight)
Assessment Title	Assessment 1: Project Proposal Assessment 2: Project Dissertation Assessment 3: Project Viva Voce
Things to include:	Project Proposal to include: • Background and Rationale • Project Aim and Objectives • Short Literature Review • Research Methodology • Project Schedule (i.e. Gantt chart) Dissertation The Dissertation report is expected to be around 12,000 words (including the updated 3000 words from the proposal) that synthesises the knowledge gained from the initial

	research activities to create an artefact or evaluate the data collected. It must take into consideration appropriate and relevant academic, ethical and professional requirements. Viva voce You will give a presentation and a formal Viva Voce of your work. You will present your findings and conclusions to the project supervisor(s) and where appropriate second supervisors, external examiners and/or industry mentors may also be invited.
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Completion of this assessment will address the following learning outcomes:	
1	Plan a research informed project using appropriate literature and/or professional outputs
2	Assess the value of theoretical concepts and, where appropriate, consider how they may be applied to the solution of real problems.
3	Design an artefact/data-gathering strategy using appropriate techniques and tools.
4	Implement a design to produce an artefact/gather the data using appropriate techniques.
5	Critically evaluate and reflect on the implementation of the artefact/data collected and the overall project.

Referencing Style

- BCU Harvard

More information on referencing is available here: <https://www.bcu.ac.uk/library/services-and-support/referencing>

Use of Artificial Intelligence

Whilst AI tools can be helpful in assisting learning, when it comes to assessment, the [Academic Misconduct Procedure](#) is clear that this should be a student's own original work and not the work of other people or AI tools.

The [Use of AI Tools – Student Guidelines](#) follows the same guidelines your lecturers use. If you are unsure of whether AI is appropriate within your work, please read the guidelines or ask your lecturer. For advice and guidance around academic writing, please visit the [Centre for Academic Success](#).

Academic Integrity Guidance

Academic Integrity means completing and submitting your own original work while properly acknowledging sources. Following academic conventions, such as referencing and citation, helps avoid plagiarism. The [Centre for Academic Success](#) offers resources on Moodle, workshops and 1-2-1 support to improve skills like paraphrasing and referencing.

Academic Misconduct

Academic misconduct is conduct that has or may have the effect of providing you with an unfair advantage by relying on dishonest means to gain advantage and which therefore compromises your academic integrity.

The [Academic Misconduct Procedure](#) sets out the process we will follow, and the penalties we may apply, in cases where we believe you may have compromised your academic integrity by committing academic misconduct.

Word Count

The maximum word count for this module assessment is shown on Page 1. A +10% margin of tolerance is applied, beyond which nothing further will be marked. Marks cannot be awarded for any learning outcomes addressed outside the word count.

The word count refers to everything in the main body of the text (including headings, tables, citations, quotes, lists etc.). Everything before (i.e. abstract, acknowledgements, contents, executive summaries etc.) and after (i.e. references, bibliographies, appendices etc) is **not** included in the word count limit.

Submission Information

Present any written aspects of the assessment using font size 11 and using 1.5 spacing to allow for comments and annotations to be added by the markers.

Complete the appropriate cover sheet for this assessment and append your work.

This assessment will be marked anonymously and should show your student number only.

Submit this coursework assessment task via Moodle.

Late Submission

Where you are required to submit assessment by a certain deadline (for example essays, case studies or physical artifacts) but you fail to meet the deadline, your mark will be reduced in accordance with the [Late Submissions Policy](#). This Policy does not apply where the assessment is 'in-person' such as exams and in-class tests.

For support on submission, please review the [Submitting Your Assignment](#) e-learning resource.

Marking Criteria:

Table of Assessment Criteria and Associated Grading Criteria

Task 1: Project Proposal

Assessment Criteria	1. Background and Rationale (Aims & Objectives)	2. Literature Review	3. Research Methodology	4. Project Schedule (i.e. Gantt chart)	5. Structure and Coherence of Proposal
Weighting:	25%	20%	30%	15%	10%
0 – 29%	No suitable Background /rationale and little indication of being aware of project background. Aim & Objectives are not suitable. No attempt to discuss with supervisor or Project Module Co-ordinator.	Few items of literature. Poor quality. Non-academic sources. Very descriptive account. No synthesis of ideas. No academic appraisal	No consideration has been given to the methods for achieving the objectives.	No evidence of project schedule	Proposal requires major drafting/re-drafting in most or all sections
30 – 39%	Very limited suitable Background/rationale and little indication of being aware of project background. Aim & Objectives are not suitable. No attempt to discuss with supervisor or Project Module Co-ordinator.	Few academic sources. No attempt made at Literature analysis. No academic argument. Mix of descriptive / appraisal of literature. No synthesis of ideas. No academic appraisal.	Limited consideration has been given to the methods for achieving the objectives.	Project schedule either incoherent or Lacking awareness of basic milestones requirements for the project, or lacking relevant content.	Serious shortcomings in structure and/or content presentation. There may be some error or lack of evidence in citing references in the proposal.

40 – 49%	Limited project background/rationale discussed. An aim has been proposed and basic objectives have been identified, but the set of objectives are incomplete to achieve the stated project aim.	Mix of academic and non-academic source. Superficial attempt made at Literature analysis. No academic argument. Compares Literature. Utilises existing theoretical models. No idea appraisal.	There has been fair consideration of methods to be used to achieve the aim of the project, but not appropriately contextualised	Some deficiencies of key milestones and deliverables, lacking clarity, and/or with little impact and some errors. There may be indication of a shortage of planning creating the schedule. However, it adequately presents some of the main milestones/deliverable.	Proposal includes some elements but there may be omissions or shortcomings in logical order, such as inappropriate use of sections, figures and appendices. The text may have significant shortcomings in style, language and/or lack of conciseness. It may not be straightforward to follow, but enough indication of ability to suggest some additional work should lead to a pass standard.
50 – 59%	Evidence of good discussion of project background/rationale Objectives required to achieve the aim have been adequately identified. Further refinement of the aim and objectives may be needed to improve consistency and coherence	Mostly academic sources. Genuine attempt made at Literature analysis. Some academic argument. Compares diverse sources. Adapts existing theoretical models. Some idea appraisal. Compares	Appropriate methods/technique s have been identified to support achievement of all the objectives. Further consideration needs to be given to alternative methods that could be used.	Reasonable specification of key milestones and deliverables within reliable time frame, although these may be overdetailed or, in part, lacking a clarity and/or including minor errors.	Proposal generally follows guidelines including all main elements. There may be some shortcomings in clarity of both text and visual presentation and some minor omissions of content.

60 – 69%	Evidence of good discussion of project background/rationale. Complete and logical set of objectives to achieve the stated aim. The scope of the project is limited with undemanding objectives.	Use of relevant research papers. Good analyses of literature Compares different sources critically. Constructs conceptual model derived from sources.	A range of suitable methods/techniques have been identified to support achievement of all the objectives. Alternative methods/approaches have been considered and there is clear justification for those selected. Some limitations of the methods have not been specified and further evaluation of alternative methods and the rationale for those selected is needed.	Good specification of key milestones and deliverables within reliable time frame, generally, clear and error free.	No significant shortcoming in the proposal structure with all the main elements included and appropriately referenced, although there may be some minor deficiencies.
70 – 79%	Evidence of very good discussion of project background/rationale. Complete and logical set of objectives to achieve the stated aim. A consistent set of demanding objectives to achieve project challenging aim.	Good focus on up-to-date research papers. Detailed analyses of literature. Demonstration of strengths/weakness of literature using academic argument. Critical comparison of quality research papers. Constructs conceptual model derived from these sources.	A wide range of appropriate methods/techniques have been identified to support achievement of all the objectives. Alternative methods/approaches have been considered and there is justification for those selected. There is awareness of limitations of the methods and suggestions to overcome them, but there may be a small number not identified.	Very good specification of key milestones and deliverables within reliable time frame, extremely clear	Proposal includes all necessary elements and appropriately referenced throughout. There are appropriate supporting appendices.

80 – 90%	Evidence of excellent discussion of project background/rationale. A complete, consistent and comprehensive set of demanding objectives to achieve a challenging aim.	Very good focus on up-to-date, highly rated research papers. Detailed analyses of literature. Demonstration of strengths/weakness of literature using academic argument. Compares different high quality research papers critically. Constructs conceptual model derived from these sources.	A wide range of appropriate methods/techniques have been identified to support achievement of all the objectives. Alternative methods/approaches have been considered and there is justification for those selected. There is an awareness of the limitations of the methods and suggestions to overcome them have been exhaustively identified.	Excellent specification of key milestones and deliverables within reliable time frame, extremely clear	Proposal includes all necessary elements and appropriately referenced throughout. There are appropriate supporting appendices. Report includes all necessary elements and is a demonstration of ability to produce professional quality documentation.
90 – 100%	Outstanding discussion of project background/rationale. A complete, consistent and outstanding comprehensive set of demanding objectives to achieve a challenging aim written at the standard for academic publication	Outstanding focus on up-to-date, highly rated research papers. Detailed analyses of literature. Demonstration of strengths/weakness of literature using academic argument at the standard for academic publication. Compares different high quality research papers critically. Constructs conceptual model derived from these sources.	An exceptional wide range of appropriate methods/techniques have been identified to support achievement of all the objectives. Alternative methods/approaches have been considered and there is justification for those selected. There is awareness of limitations of the methods and suggestions to overcome them have been exhaustively identified.	Proposal schedule is presented to the highest standard and captures an outstanding specification of key milestones and deliverables within reliable time frame, extremely clear. The details associated with all the planned tasks demonstrate that the project is completed within the overall time available.	Proposal presented to the highest standard. Outstanding academic style and language in accordance with guidelines and with no shortcomings.

Task 2: Dissertation

Assessment Criteria →	LO2 Assess the value of theoretical concepts and, where appropriate, consider how they may be applied to the solution of real problems	LO3 Design an artefact/data-gathering strategy using appropriate techniques and tools.	LO4 Implement a design to produce an artefact/gather the data using appropriate techniques.
Weighting:	25%	35%	40%

0 – 29%	No assessment of the value of theoretical concepts	No evidence of the design of an artefact nor data-gathering strategy using appropriate techniques and tools	No implementation of a design to produce an artefact/gather the data using appropriate techniques
30 – 39%	Inadequate assessment of the value of theoretical concepts. No consideration of how they may be applied to the solution of real problems	There are deficiencies and/lack of clarity in the design of an artefact/data-gathering strategy using appropriate techniques and tools	There are deficiencies and/lack of clarity in the implementation of a design to produce an artefact/gather the data using appropriate techniques.
40 – 49%	Basic assessment of the value of theoretical concepts. Basic consideration of how they may be applied to the solution of real problems.	Basic design of an artefact/data-gathering strategy using appropriate techniques and tools.	Limited implementation of a design to produce an artefact/gather the data using appropriate techniques.
50 – 59%	Satisfactory assessment of the value of theoretical concepts. However, the consideration of how they may be applied to the solution of real problems has not been demonstrated.	Reasonable design of an artefact/data-gathering strategy using appropriate techniques and tools with minor errors.	A satisfactory implementation of a design to produce an artefact/gather the data using appropriate techniques. There are some errors in the implementation.
60 – 69%	Good assessment of the value of theoretical concepts with references to some relevant literature. Good consideration of how they may be applied to the solution of real problems has been demonstrated.	Good design of an artefact/data-gathering strategy using appropriate techniques and tools, clear and error free.	Good implementation of a design to produce an artefact/gathering of data using appropriate techniques. Improvement in the implementation is necessary.
70 – 79%	Very good assessment of the value of theoretical concepts with very good attempt at references to relevant literature from credible sources using the correct citation style. Good consideration of how the concepts may be applied to the solution of real problems has been demonstrated.	Very good design of an artefact/data-gathering strategy using appropriate techniques and tools with clear analysis of the applied techniques and tools.	Very good implementation of a design to produce an artefact/gathering of data using appropriate techniques.

80 – 89%	Excellent assessment of the value of theoretical concepts. Excellent references to relevant literature from credible sources using the correct citation style throughout. Excellent demonstration of the consideration of how the concepts may be applied to the solution of real problems.	Excellent demonstration of the design of an artefact/data-gathering strategy using appropriate techniques and tools with clear analysis highlighting the strength and weaknesses of the applied techniques and tools.	An excellent implementation of a design to produce an artefact/gathering of data using appropriate techniques. End product is relevant to solving real life problem.
90 -100%	Outstanding and high impact assessment of the value of theoretical concepts outstanding references to relevant literature from credible sources using the correct citation style throughout. Outstanding and very constructive demonstration of the consideration of how the concepts may be applied to the solution of real problems.	Outstanding demonstration of the design of an artefact/data-gathering strategy using appropriate and challenging techniques and tools with clear and meticulous analysis highlighting the strength and weaknesses of the applied techniques and tools to a publishable standard.	An outstanding implementation of a design to produce high quality artefact/gathering of data using appropriate techniques. End product is relevant to solving real life problem and the result is of publishable standard.

Task 3: Viva voce

Assessment Criteria → LO5: Critically evaluate and reflect on the implementation of the artefact/data collected and the overall project.	1. Presentation Visual	2. Presentation Verbal	3. Clarity of critical evaluation and reflection on the implementation of the artefact/data collected and the overall project	4. Q&A/Discussion
Weighting:	15%	20%	40%	25%
0 – 29%	Slides either incoherent or lacking awareness of basic presentation requirements, or relevant content	Major shortcomings in clarity and/or relevance.	Main insufficiencies in artefact through considerable incompleteness or lack of competence in artefact ideas or description. Insufficient critical evaluation and reflection on the implementation of the artefact/data collected and the overall project.	Responses are incoherent or display lack of essential knowledge and/or relevance.

	30 – 39%	Slides lack information on key aspects of project, too text-heavy.	Presentation lacks clarity and / or relevance. There is sufficient evidence to suggest that some more preparation is required.	Unclear project aims and objectives, lacking in design and specification requirements. Insufficient critical evaluation and reflection on the implementation of the artefact/data collected and the overall project.	Serious shortfall in ability to explain fundamentals.
	40 – 49%	Some deficiencies of key points, lacking clarity, and/or with little impact and some errors. There may be indication of a shortage of planning and care in composing / creating the presentation. However, it should be able to attain pass standard with some additional time in preparation.	Presentation not well Planned/delivered. Conveys basic information. Significant deficiencies in content / clarity / interest although a little more preparations would have achieved a pass mark.	Demonstrates ideas/ability to design, linked to aims and objectives, but unchallenging and limited specification. Significant shortcomings in defining requirements. Limited critical evaluation and reflection on the implementation of the artefact/data collected and the overall project. However, following on to product development could lead to a pass	Limited Demonstration of understanding of essential ideas of the project. Inability to answer basic questions successfully.
	50 – 59%	Reasonable encapsulation of key points, although these may be overdetailed or, in part, lacking a clear message and / or including minor errors.	Fair description of major features and requirements, some aspects lack clarity.	Generally competent concept to a satisfactory design for unchallenging specification meeting a reasonable project aim and objectives. Some thought given to user requirements. Appropriate design approach. Satisfactory critical evaluation and reflection on the implementation of the artefact/data collected and the overall project.	Reasonable responses to questions and is able adequately to discuss straightforward aspects. There may be some deficiencies in knowledge.

	60 – 69%	Good encapsulation of key points, generally clear, with good impact and error free.	Good verbal description of main features of project; straightforward to follow, confident and interesting.	Competent concept and design with aspects of originality. Consideration has been given to specifications with few minor deficiencies. Clear link to good project aims and objectives and underpinning research and design approaches. Good critical evaluation and reflection on the implementation of the artefact/data collected and the overall project.	Good responses to questions and in discussion appears to be generally familiar with the specific topic with relevant wider issues.
	70 – 79%	Very good encapsulation of key points, very clear, high impact slides with useful figures.	Well planned, coherent oral presentation expressed with confidence and interest. Clear explanation of important concepts.	Very good concept, high level of design and innovation. Takes into account user / audience requirements. Clear link to good project aims and smart objectives with appropriate underpinning research and effective design approach. Very good critical evaluation and reflection on the implementation of the artefact/data collected and the overall project.	Confident, succinct and informative responses to questions. In discussion, appears to be well informed on specific subject knowledge as well as wider issues associated with the project.
	80 – 89%	Excellent encapsulation of key points, very clear, high impact slides with useful figures.	Well planned, coherent oral presentation expressed with confidence and interest. Presentation appropriate to the audience. Very good summarisation of aims, approach, activity and progress	Excellent concept, high level of design and innovation. Takes into account user / audience requirements. Clear link to good project aims and smart objectives with appropriate underpinning research and effective design approach. Excellent critical evaluation and reflection on the implementation of the artefact/data collected and the overall project.	High level of confident, succinct and informative responses to questions. Clearly well informed on specific subject knowledge as well as wider issues associated with the project.

90 -100%	Outstanding presentation of slides of the high standard, error free	An outstanding presentation of a high standard	An outstanding concept and design of the highest standard. Clearly defines use case and addressing requirements. Outstanding link to project aims and smart objectives and excellent underpinning research for an outstanding and design approach of publishable standard. An outstanding critical evaluation and reflection on the implementation of the artefact/data collected and the overall project.	Outstanding confident, succinct and detailed responses to questions. In discussion, student demonstrated outstanding competence on all subject knowledge raised as well as wider issues associated with the project. Demonstration of an impressive level of project knowledge.
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